

ORI ZAFF

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EDUCATION

- MA** University of Delaware, Linguistics & Cognitive Science Grad: *June 2019*
Advisor: Dr. Irene Vogel
- BS** University of Delaware, Cognitive Science Grad: *May 2018*
Honors Award, Departmental Scholarship Award, Dean's List 2014-2018

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

TBI Research Initiative, University of Pennsylvania *Sept 2023 - Sept 2026*
Senior Clinical Research Coordinator, PI: Dr. Ramon Diaz-Arrastia

- Project: Assessment of microvascular injury and clinical outcomes after trauma
- Leadership and delegation of responsibility to the coordinator team
- Design and startup for multi-site human neuroimaging study
- Analysis of cerebrovascular reactivity fMRI data and diffusion tensor imaging
- Clinical trial IRB protocol setup, management, and modification
- Approaching, assessing, and enrolling acute care patients directly following injury
- Administering and evaluating cognitive assessments

Neuroeconomics Lab, Temple University *Aug 2021 - August 2023*
Research Coordinator, PI: Dr. David V. Smith

- Project: Social reward processing across the lifespan
- Coordinating longitudinal R01 research project
- fMRI data collection and data processing
- Data analysis in Python, MATLAB, R, and SPSS, as well as BASH scripting
- Creating project materials ranging from IRB documents to experimental tasks
- Training and managing 10 research assistants in data collection, scoring, and analysis

IBM, Computational Psychiatry and Neuroimaging Department *Jun - Aug 2018*
Summer Student, PIs: Dr. Guillermo Cecchi, Dr. Mary Pietrowicz

- Project: Mental health trajectory detection by sentiment analysis
- Feature selection for Watson Natural Language Understanding AI pipeline

Shohamy Learning Lab, Columbia University *May - Aug 2016*
Research Assistant, PI: Dr. Daphna Shohamy

- Project: Experiments studying effects of reward salience on graded and retroactive prioritization of memory
- Collected human subject fMRI data and constructed experimental materials

Child's Play Lab, University of Delaware *Aug - Dec 2015*

Research Assistant, PI: Dr. Roberta Golinkoff

- Project: Effects of Geometric Toy Design on Parent-Child Interactions and Spatial Language
- Collected and analyzed observational data from child participants

MANUSCRIPTS PUBLISHED & IN PREPARATION

Smith, D. V., **Zaff, O.**, Wyngaarden, J. B., Dennison, J. B., Sazhin, D., Chein, J., Alloy, L. B., McCloskey, M., Jarcho, J. M., Fareri, D. (2025). Social Context and Reward Sensitivity Enhance Corticostriatal Function during Experiences of Shared Rewards. Preprint available on [bioRxiv](https://doi.org/10.1101/2025.01.15.433333).

Wyngaarden, J. B., Johnston, C. R., Sazhin, D., Dennison, J. B., **Zaff, O.**, Fareri, D., McCloskey, M., Alloy, L. B., Smith, D. V., Jarcho, J. M. (2024). Corticostriatal Responses to Social Reward are Linked to Trait Reward Sensitivity and Substance Use in Young Adults. *Social Cognitive and Affective Neuroscience*, 19(1). <https://doi.org/10.1093/scan/nsae033>.

Smith, D. V., Wyngaarden, J., Sharp, C. J., Sazhin, D., **Zaff, O.**, Jarcho, J., Fareri, D. (2023). An fMRI dataset of social and nonsocial reward processing in young adults. *Data In Brief*, 53. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.dib.2024.110197>.

Sazhin, D., Wyngaarden, J. B., Dennison, J. B., **Zaff, O.**, Fareri, D., McCloskey, M., Alloy, L. B., Jarcho, J. M., Smith, D. V. (2023). Trait Reward Sensitivity Modulates Connectivity with the Temporoparietal Junction and Anterior Insula during Strategic Decision Making. *Biological Psychology*, 192. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.biopsycho.2024.108857>.

Smith, D. V., Dennison, J., **Zaff, O.**, Wyngaarden, J., Sharp, C., Dowdle, L., Jarcho, J., Olson, I., Rorden, C., & Fareri, D. (in prep). Characterizing the effects of multiecho and multiband imaging on corticostriatal responses to reward.

POSTERS

Zaff, O., Walter, A., Parker, D., Darnley, S., Kalyani, P. Anderson, G. Chan, A., Ware, J., Verma, R., Diaz-Arrastia, R. (June, 2024). *Trajectories of traumatic axonal injury as measured by diffusion tensor imaging*. National Neurotrauma Society; San Francisco, USA.

Zaff, O., Yang, Y., Wyngaarden, J. B., Dachs, A., Sharp, C., Collins, M. J., Sazhin, D., Ludwig, R. M., Giovannetti, T., Fareri, D. S., Smith, D. V. (November, 2023). *Associations between Age and Neural Response to Reward in Social Contexts*. Society for Neuroscience; Washington D.C., USA.

Wyngaarden, J. B., **Zaff, O.**, Sazhin, D., Dachs, A., Collins, M., Johnston, C. R., Giovannetti, T., Jarcho, J. M., Smith, D. V. (November, 2023). *Age-Related Differences in Social Reward Processing*. Society for Neuroscience; Washington D.C., USA.

Sazhin, D., Wyngaarden, J. B., **Zaff, O.**, Ludwig, R. M., Collins, M., Sharp, C., Dachs, A., Nambiar, A., Dennison, J. B., Drayton, M., Tropea, T., Clithero, J. A., Giovannetti, T., Smith, D. V. (November, 2023). *Characterizing Age-Related Differences in Neural*

- Responses During the Ultimatum Game*. Society for Neuroscience; Washington D.C., USA.
- Dachs, A., Sharp, C. J., Yanilmaz, E., Wyngaarden, J. B., **Zaff, O.**, Tropea, T., Sazhin, D., Ludwig, R. M., Giovannetti, T., Fareri, D. S., Smith, D. V. (November, 2023). *Examining Age-Related Differences in Neural Responses to Trust*. Society for Neuroscience; Washington D.C., USA.
- Smith, D. V., Dennison, J. B., **Zaff, O.**, Wyngaarden, J. B., Collins, M., Dowdle, L., Jarcho, J., Olson, I., Inglis, B., Morgan, P., Rorden, C., Fareri, D. S. (July, 2023). *Characterizing the Effects of Multiecho and Multiband Imaging on Corticostriatal Responses to Reward*. Organization for Human Brain Mapping; Montreal, Canada.
- Wyngaarden JB, Sharp CJ, Dennison JB, Sazhin D, **Zaff, O.**, Olson I, Fareri DS, Jarcho J, Smith DV (July, 2023). *Task-Dependent Functional Connectivity with the Cerebellum is Confounded by Nyquist Ghosting*. Organization for Human Brain Mapping; Montreal, Canada.
- Zaff, O.**, Dennison, J. B., Sazhin, D., Wyngaarden, J. B., Vafiadis, A., Collins, M., Nguyen, A., Chein, J., Alloy, L., Jarcho, J., Fareri, D., Smith, D. V. (November, 2022). *Individual Differences in Substance Use are Associated with Elevated Temporoparietal Junction Responses to Rewards Shared with Friends*. Society for Neuroscience; San Diego, CA, USA.
- Sazhin, D., Dennison, J. B., Wyngaarden, J., **Zaff, O.**, Vafiadis, A., Kahn, N., Collins, M., Nguyen, A., Kohli, I., Fareri, D., McCloskey, M., Alloy, L., Jarcho, J., Smith, D. V. (November, 2022). *When Do We Choose to Be Fair? Strategic Choices in Bargaining Situations Are Associated with Elevated Corticostriatal Connectivity*. Society for Neuroscience; San Diego, CA, USA.
- Sazhin, D., Dennison, J., Wyngaarden, J., Vafiadis, A., **Zaff, O.**, Kahn, N., Collins, M., Nguyen, A., Kohli, I., Fareri, D., McCloskey, M., Jarcho, J., Smith, D.V. (May, 2022). *Strategic Decisions in Bargaining Situations Are Associated with Activation in the Caudate*. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society. [Virtual meeting due to COVID-19]
- Wyngaarden, J. B., Johnston, C. R., Sazhin, D., Dennison, J. B., Vafiadis, A., **Zaff, O.**, Kahn, N., A., Collins, M., Nguyen, A., Fareri, D., McCloskey, M., Alloy, L., Smith, D. V., Jarcho, J. M. (May, 2022). *Alcohol Use is Associated with Enhanced Corticostriatal Connectivity with Precuneus During Social Reward*. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society. [Virtual meeting due to COVID-19]

TEACHING/LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Traumatic Brain Injury Support Group

Sept 2023 - Present

Facilitates monthly discussion-based support group meetings as community outreach initiative

Trauma Literature Discussion Group

Sept 2021 - Aug 2023

Presents on emerging research at a monthly discussion group for literature surrounding trauma and adverse childhood experiences

Congregations Kol Ami & Emanu-el, White Plains, NY

Sept 2019 - June 2021

Hebrew Language Teacher, 4th - 6th grade, and High School Leadership Program

University of Delaware, Newark, DE
Teaching Assistant, Dr. Mende-Siedlecki, Research Methods

Feb - May 2019

University of Delaware, Newark, DE
Workshop Instructor, Dr. Graves, General Chemistry

Sept - Dec 2015

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

ExposeBox, Tel Aviv *Jun 2017 - Jan 2018*

Quality Assurance Engineer, UI/UX troubleshooting and redesign, client support

SYFY, NBC/Universal, New York, NY *Nov 2018 - July 2019*

Correspondent, new & old media content creation, voice design, and high-stakes interviews

SKILLS

Programming Experience: Python, BASH Scripting (and Command Line Interfacing), R, Visual Basic, MATLAB, HTML

Software: FSL, Microsoft Word/Excel/PowerPoint, Adobe Creative Suite, GingerALE, REDCap, PennChart (Epic), Sketch-Up & Makerware 3D Design/Printing

Hardware: Siemens 3T fMRI operation, Blood Pressure Monitor, Professional Digital Audio/Video Recording Equipment

CERTIFICATIONS

Temple University Brain Imaging Research & Imaging Center - Scan Technician Access (Level 3)

UPenn Center for Magnetic Resonance Imaging and Spectroscopy - Scanner Operating Access (Level 2)

Suicide Prevention Resource Center - Strategic Planning Approach to Suicide Prevention, & Locating and Understanding Data for Suicide Prevention

CITI - Social & Behavioral, Good Clinical Practices, Responsible Conduct of Research

ACRP - Clinical Trials, Informed Consent, Ethics and Human Subject Protection

Epic for Researchers - Complete PennChart Clinical Coordinator Training

REDCap - HIPAA Best Practices Training

Phlebotomy Training - Procedures for blood draw (Perivascular Nurse Consultants)

LANGUAGES

English (native)

Hebrew (near native)